Seneca on Saving Time

Where does your time actually go?

READING · ONE LETTER

Seneca, Letter 1 (“On Saving Time”). Most of our time is taken from us, stolen, or simply slips away. Seneca urges Lucilius to hold on to every hour. A good first letter for a group that wants to read Seneca together.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Link the letter in your announcement and ask members to read it beforehand. It’s about two pages.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Ground rules; welcome newcomers	Key passages aloud	The questions below	Plan one hour	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Seneca says time is taken, stolen, or slips away. Which is most true for you?
2. He says we are dying every day. What changes if you take that seriously?
3. Is being busy a problem, or a badge of honor?
4. What would “holding every hour” look like in your week?
5. If the group read one letter a month, what theme would you want next?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Claim an hour. Once a day, before an hour begins, decide what it’s for. Notice where it went.

FACILITATOR’S MOVE

“Can you give an example?” Ask for a specific hour this week that slipped away.

NOTES